

How Abundly's Partnership Model Helps Companies Succeed With AI Agents

Executive Summary

Most organizations that invest in AI agents fail to capture their value. Agents get built, deployed, and then sit unused. The core reason is the black box problem: someone builds an agent, but the people who should use it don't understand how it works. They can't iterate or improve it. It's never good enough on the first try, and nobody can fix it.

The only way out of the black box problem is to empower domain experts—the people who work directly with specific workflows—to build and work with their own AI agents. This is our philosophy: augmentation over automation. If we build your agents for you, we have failed.

Abundly offers Agent Success as a Service—a partnership model that combines platform, training, and advisory to make this empowerment possible. We work with your internal coalition to move through three phases: Foundation, Factory, and Fleet. Organizations that complete this journey build human+AI teams that outcompete those who wait.

Generative AI Is Two Shifts, Not One

When people talk about generative AI, they typically think of one major shift. In reality, there are two distinct transformations happening, and most organizations are only addressing the first.

The First Shift: AI as a Helpful Tool

The first shift came with ChatGPT and similar tools. Static software became conversational AI for individuals. People can now get instant answers, draft documents, and explore ideas through natural conversation. This is valuable, but it's fundamentally still a tool that humans use—you ask, it answers.

The Second Shift: AI as a Coworker

The second shift is more profound. AI moves from answering questions to taking autonomous action. These are AI agents—digital colleagues that can carry out knowledge work on your behalf. An agent doesn't wait for you to ask a question. It monitors your inbox, processes documents, coordinates tasks, and proactively reaches out when something needs attention.

This second shift is where the significant value lies. An AI agent can work 24/7, handle scale that humans cannot, and free your team to focus on work that requires human judgment and creativity.

Abundly is fully focused on this second shift—on AI agents. We help organizations build human+AI teams where agents and people work side by side as colleagues.

Why Most Agent Initiatives Fail

Everyone talks about building and deploying agents. What few acknowledge is that most agents end up sitting unused. The pattern is remarkably consistent:

1. IT purchases an AI agent platform
2. Someone builds an agent
3. The people who should use it don't understand how it works
4. It becomes a black box—nobody can iterate or improve it
5. The agent is never quite good enough (and agents are rarely perfect on the first try)
6. It sits unused, and the investment is wasted

This is the black box problem. The knowledge of how the agent works sits with whoever built it—often an external vendor or a single technical person. The domain experts who actually need to use and improve the agent are locked out.

And here's the critical insight: agents need continuous iteration. Workflows change. Edge cases appear. Users have feedback. An agent that can't be improved is an agent that will eventually fail.

The black box problem is why most agent initiatives fail. The solution isn't better technology or more features. The solution is ensuring the right people can build and iterate on their own agents.

Our Philosophy: Augmentation Over Automation

At the core of everything we do is a simple but powerful belief: **if we build your agents for you, we have failed.**

This may sound counterintuitive from a company that helps build agents. But consider the alternative: we build an agent, hand it over, and leave. What happens when something breaks? When the workflow changes? When someone wants to improve how the agent works? You're dependent on external help for every iteration. You're stuck in the black box.

Our philosophy centers on augmentation over automation. We believe in empowering domain experts—the people who work directly with specific workflows—to build and continuously work with their own AI agents. These are the people who understand the nuances, who will notice when something isn't quite right, and who can iterate quickly to make improvements.

This approach requires more investment upfront than simply outsourcing agent development. But it creates sustainable value. Your organization develops the muscle to work with AI agents. You can onboard new agents faster. You can adapt as circumstances change. You're not dependent on anyone.

The organizations that take this path build genuine competitive advantage. Those that take shortcuts end up with expensive technology that nobody uses.

What Agent Success Requires

Empowering domain experts to build and work with their own agents doesn't happen automatically. It requires working across four interconnected dimensions:

Dimension	What It Means
Strategy	Clarity on what you're trying to accomplish. Which use cases will deliver the most value? What's the prioritized roadmap?
Operations	Hands-on work with specific workflows. Where can agents add value? How do you redesign processes for human+AI collaboration?
People	Identifying and activating champions. Building capabilities. Bringing the organization along.
IT/Tech	Platform access and tooling. Security and governance as you scale.

Addressing only one or two of these dimensions guarantees failure. The organizations that succeed work on all four together. This is what we mean by Agent Success—not just building agents, but everything needed to actually succeed with them.

The Journey: Foundation, Factory, Fleet

The path to Agent Success follows three phases. Each builds on the last, and attempting to skip phases leads to failure.

Foundation: Getting the Basics Right

Foundation is about establishing the core elements you need before you can scale. This is where most organizations should start, and many never get beyond this phase because they rush ahead without solid foundations.

What Foundation involves:

Dimension	Foundation Activities
Strategy	Opportunity mapping across your organization. Creating an initial roadmap of potential agent use cases, prioritized by value and feasibility.
Operations	Building your first production agent. Doing targeted process re-engineering to understand how agents fit into real workflows.
People	Assembling your coalition—sponsor, lead, and initial champions. Training this core group so they understand agents deeply.
IT/Tech	Ensuring your team has access to an appropriate agent platform. Basic setup and configuration.

What success looks like: Your coalition is trained and energized. You have at least one agent in production, delivering real value. You have a clear view of where agents could add value across your organization. You're ready to scale.

Typical timeline: 4-8 weeks

Factory: Scaling Agent Development

Once foundations are solid, Factory is where the real value creation begins. This phase is about developing the organizational muscle to build many agents. Before you can become sophisticated about governance and optimization, you need to learn how to build.

What Factory involves:

Dimension	Factory Activities
Strategy	Moving from initial roadmap to comprehensive vision. Re-prioritizing based on what you've learned. Understanding how agents could transform your value proposition.
Operations	Building and refining a portfolio of agents. Multiple agents in production across different parts of the organization.
People	Broad capability building. Champions across the organization learning to build and work with agents. Basic AI literacy for everyone.
IT/Tech	Scaling platform access. More users, more use cases, more complexity.

What success looks like: You have many agents in production, creating value across multiple workflows. Champions throughout your organization can build agents with minimal support. The organization is becoming comfortable working alongside AI colleagues.

Typical timeline: 3-6 months

Fleet: Governing and Optimizing

Fleet is where you transition from building agents to managing a fleet of them. You now have many AI coworkers operating across your organization. How do you ensure they're creating value? How do you maintain appropriate oversight? How do you continuously improve?

What Fleet involves:

Dimension	Fleet Activities
Strategy	Revisiting your value proposition. Understanding how AI agents change what you can offer customers and how you operate. Developing a mature operating model for human+AI teams.
Operations	Establishing enabling infrastructure for many agents. Collaboration frameworks. Monitoring and optimization at scale.
People	Full change management. Helping the entire organization adapt to working with AI colleagues. Managing the cultural shift.
IT/Tech	Governance, guardrails, and controls. Security oversight. Ensuring the fleet operates safely and effectively.

What success looks like: You have human+AI teams operating throughout your organization. Agents are creating significant value. You have appropriate governance without stifling innovation. Your organization has developed the muscle to continuously onboard new and more powerful agents.

Typical timeline: Ongoing

Why Act Now

AI agents are becoming dramatically more powerful. Long-running agents that handle multi-day tasks are becoming viable. Multi-agent collaboration is emerging. The agents available in two years will be far more capable than those available today.

This creates a diverging path:

Organizations that prepare now move through Foundation, Factory, and Fleet. They develop the muscle to work with agents. When more powerful agents become available, they can onboard them quickly.

Organizations that wait will eventually need to adopt agents—competitive pressure will demand it. But they'll be starting from zero while competitors operate at scale.

The journey to agent-readiness takes time. The organizations that start now will have a sustained advantage.

Why Partner With Abundly

Our Philosophy Sets Us Apart

The first reason to work with Abundly is our commitment to augmentation over automation. We don't create dependency. We measure success by how capable your organization becomes—not by how much you need us.

This means we prioritize capability transfer in every engagement. We don't just build agents—we teach your champions to build agents. We don't just solve problems—we help your team understand solutions so they can handle similar challenges independently.

We Provide Everything You Need, Integrated

Many vendors sell platform, training, or consulting separately. Buying from multiple vendors means nobody is responsible for the overall outcome.

We combine platform, training, and advisory into one integrated service. The platform is built by people who understand organizational change. The training is delivered by people who build production agents. The advisory is informed by what we learn from thousands of users and engagements. Everything reinforces everything else.

We De-risk Your Adoption

Adopting AI agents is a hard challenge. Many organizations have invested in AI initiatives that didn't deliver. Our partnership model is designed to de-risk this adoption. We've seen what works and what doesn't across hundreds of engagements.

We Have Deep Experience

We have worked with over 200 organizations on adopting generative AI and agents. We have trained thousands of professionals. We have built countless production agents. This experience compounds—every engagement teaches us something that helps the next customer succeed faster.

How We Work Together

Your Coalition

Successful agent adoption requires internal commitment. We work with your core coalition:

Role	Responsibility
Sponsor	Senior leader who ensures organizational commitment and removes blockers
Lead	Project manager who coordinates activities and ensures things happen
Champions	Individuals who build agents, find use cases, and bring colleagues on board
Learning & Development	Ensures capability building happens systematically
IT/Tech	Ensures agent adoption fits your IT architecture and security requirements

What Abundly Brings

Role	What We Provide
Advisor	Strategic guidance on prioritization, roadmapping, and organizational change
Agent Lead	Hands-on expertise in building agents; coaching for your champions

Role	What We Provide
Trainers	Capability building from beginner AI literacy to advanced agent development
Platform Team	Platform support plus rapid development of capabilities you need

Starting With a Pilot

We typically begin with a pilot—a focused engagement that demonstrates value before broader commitment.

What a pilot includes:

- Training for your coalition core (lead and initial champions)
- Building your first production agent together
- Opportunity mapping to identify where agents could add value
- Clear results that demonstrate what's possible

Pilot timeline: 4-6 weeks

The pilot gives both sides confidence. You see real results and understand what working with Abundly is like. We understand your organization and opportunities. This shared understanding makes the full partnership far more effective.

Scaling to Full Partnership

After a successful pilot, we scale to a full partnership—a long-term commitment to help your entire organization succeed with AI agents.

What a partnership includes:

- Platform access across your organization
- Training from beginner to champion level
- Co-development of many agents
- Ongoing coaching and advisory

The partnership is designed to make you self-sufficient over time. In early phases, we're heavily involved. As your organization develops capability, we shift to coaching and advisory. The goal is for you to build the muscle to work with AI agents independently.

Abundly AI helps organizations build human+AI teams that multiply what they can achieve. To learn more about how a partnership could work for your organization, contact us at hello@abundly.ai or visit abundly.ai.